

1931–1944

RELAXING
THE RULES

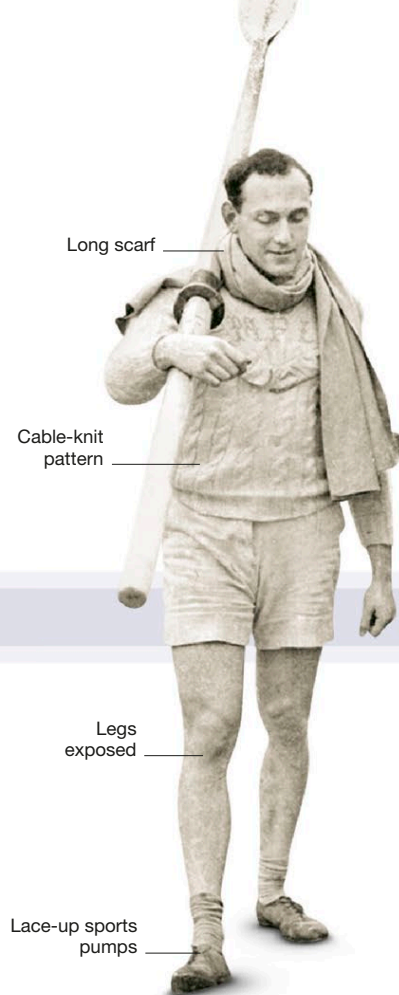
On the slopes, the tennis court, and the yacht the sartorial rules governing men's clothing in the city could be stretched or even abandoned. The move towards lighter fabrics continued, increasing the emphasis on the body underneath. In summer grey, white, beige, or striped flannels (trousers made of a light wool fabric) were popular. In England their cotton or linen equivalent – white ducks – were supposed to be paired with a blue blazer only. The sports jacket had emerged in the late 19th century when it could be seen in rowing clubs. Team blazers could be brightly coloured, striped, or have contrasting edging, and often displayed a crest or insignia on the breast pocket. The polo shirt, despite its name, was originally worn for tennis and golf and had been around for at least a decade, but now became ubiquitous.



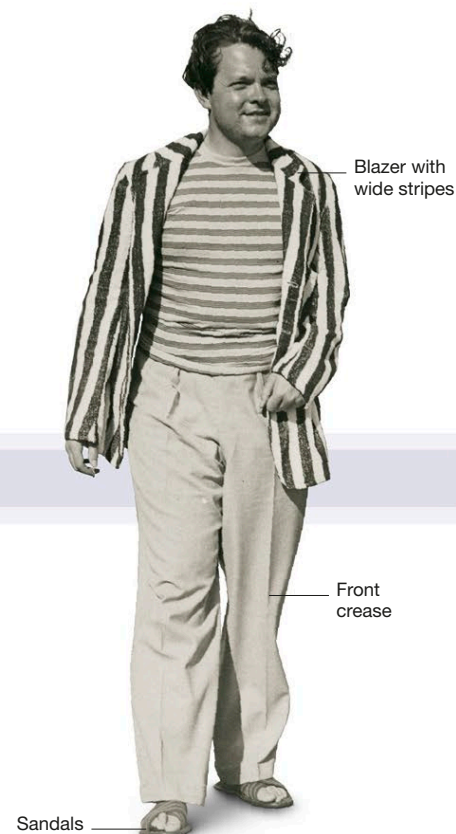
Derby day Spectators of the steeplechase at Derby Racecourse usually dressed more formally than this gentleman. His riding breeches and boots, long-skirted riding coat, and flat cap suggest he might have owned a horse or stable.



Tennis The dark V-neck of tennis legend Fred Perry's white sweater is just discernible underneath his sports jacket with club crest. A white, open-neck polo shirt completes the ensemble.



Boat race President of the Cambridge University crew for the annual boat race in 1937, this gentleman wears cotton sports shorts. He keeps warm with a thick cable-knit sweater and wool scarf.



Beach wear In 1935 *Country Life* announced that "men can get away with more in the way of colourful beach wear". This thought might have been behind Orson Welles's choice of a striped blazer and jersey, light trousers, and sandals.